



MUSCLE HANDBOOK

What is needed for a **healthy,**
strong and **beautiful body.**

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DISCLAIMER

Always consult your medical practitioner, registered dietician, or nutritionist before making any significant changes to your diet or physical activity – particularly if you are an adolescent, pregnant, breastfeeding, or have a medical condition.



INTRODUCTION

Welcome!

By downloading this muscle handbook, you have made the first steps to learning about all the different factors involved in building your strong, healthy, and beautiful body.

The process of building muscle is very intricate and requires focus in a lot of areas. Many people believe that it is all about lifting heavy weights and taking supplements, but your ability to build a strong and healthy body depends on so much more.

In this handbook, you will learn about nutrition, supplements, vitamins and minerals, training and stretching, and more.

I hope you enjoy it and make good use of it.



CALCULATE YOUR BASAL METABOLIC INDEX

BMI stands for Body Mass Index, and it determines how healthy you are based on your height and weight. This is a common method to determine whether or not you are underweight, healthy weight, overweight or obese.

HOW TO CALCULATE BMI?

It is calculated using the following formula:

$$\text{BMI} = \text{kg/m}^2$$

Let's do an example: a 32- year old lady who is 178cm tall and weighs 64kgs. So, we will firstly multiply her height by her height.

$$1.78 \times 1.78 = 3.1684$$

Then we divide her weight in kgs by the outcome.

$$64/3.1684 = \text{BMI } 20.2$$

The results show that her BMI is 20.2. Once you have the BMI, you can place it into the correct category. The classifications are shown below:

Under 18.5 – Underweight

18.5- 24.9 – Normal Weight

25.0-29.9 – Overweight

30 or greater – Obese



NUTRITION AND HEALTH

The foundations of a strong and healthy body are constructed on nutrition, which is one of the most important building components.

Nutrition plays a vital role in our ability to do anything. Whether you are looking to build muscle, lose weight, or tone up - you need proper nutrition.

You may have heard this phrase numerous times but eating a balanced diet crucial for your overall health and well-being. This is because every nutrient performs a different role in the body and they are codependent on other nutrients. This means that if you fail to obtain enough of one nutrient then the body may struggle to absorb another. This can lead to a chain reaction of nutritional deficiencies causing a number of symptoms. These deficiencies can significantly affect your health and ability to build muscle.

Therefore, eating a healthy and balanced meal should be one of your top priorities if you're looking to build a strong and healthy body.

On the next page, we will take a look at different nutrients and your requirements.



In order to keep healthy, we need to consume a variety of food to obtain different nutrients. As a result, we need a balance of macronutrients (proteins, fats and carbohydrates).

Each macronutrient provides different vitamins and minerals which support different functions in the body.

PROTEINS

This macronutrient consists of 20 amino acids and provides nutrients like calcium, phosphorus, selenium, vitamin B12, vitamin B2, and zinc, iron, vitamin E. As a result, proteins are crucial for a number of functions including:

- Healthy skin and hair
- Maintenance of healthy bones and teeth
- Muscle contraction, growth, and recovery
- Helping other nutrients to transport oxygen around the body
- Maintaining a healthy immune system

Great quality proteins include meats and poultry like chicken, turkey, lean beef, fish and seafood, venison, and dairy products. Plant-based options include nuts and seeds, tofu, edamame, lentils, beans, and soy alternatives.

To build muscle, you should consume 1g of protein per 1lb of body weight. Try to have a moderate-protein meal 3-4 hours before exercise and within 45 minutes after.



CARBOHYDRATES (CARBS)

Carbohydrates have received a lot of bad rep over the last few decades. The reason behind this is due to the way that they are digested and the hormones that they release. However, it's important to understand that this process has been widely misunderstood and exaggerated. Carbohydrates are not to blame for weight gain, and in fact, they are just as important for building muscle as proteins.

Muscles need the energy to be able to exert strength and power into each lift. This energy comes from glycogen stores. The 'glycogen stores' is just a fancy name given to sugar stores within the muscle, and this sugar comes from carbohydrates. If you don't obtain enough carbohydrates, you won't be able to train as hard and for as long as you'd like. As a result, your progress will be stalled. In addition, if you fail to obtain enough carbohydrates, you are also excluding nutrients like fibre, calcium, iron, and B vitamins.

Great sources of carbohydrates include white and brown rice, pasta, fruit and vegetables, couscous, quinoa, chia seeds, pumpkin seeds, nuts and seeds, and lentils.

Approximately 50-55% of your total calories should come from carbohydrates. Make sure to consume a high carbohydrate meal 2-3 hours before exercise and immediately after.



FATS

Fats, just like carbs, have also been misunderstood. Many people believe that eating fats will make fat accumulate in the body. However, that is not true. Unhealthy fats like saturated and trans fats have been associated with bad health and cardiovascular disease, but healthy fats are actually necessary for our health and wellbeing. They are important for various things like:

- Transports fat-soluble vitamins A, D, E, and K around the body
- Reduces appetite
- Regulates body temperature
- Provides structural support to organs like heart, liver, and kidneys

High-quality fat sources include eggs, avocados, flaxseeds and flaxseed oil, nuts and seeds as well as olive oil.

Approximately 30-35% of your total calories should come from healthy fats. Make sure to avoid consuming any fats immediately after a workout as this slows the replenishment of glycogen stores required for proper muscle recovery.



WORKOUT YOUR CALORIE REQUIREMENTS

Okay, it is time to get started! Follow the steps below to calculate your calorie requirements.

1 Workout your BMR

BMR stands for Basal Metabolic Rate. BMR is the number of calories your body is able to burn at rest.

To calculate your BMR, you need to have your weight in kilograms and height in centimetres.

Make sure to choose the correct formula!

WOMEN	MEN
10 x weight in KG + 6.25 x height in cm - 5 X AGE IN YEARS - 161 = BMR	10 x weight in KG + 6.25 x height in cm - 5 X AGE IN YEARS + 5 = BMR



2. WORKOUT YOUR TDEE

Your 'TDEE' is your total daily energy expenditure. That's the amount of calories your body needs daily.

To calculate how many calories your body needs per day, you simply need to multiply your BMR that you calculated in the first step by your activity factor.

SEDENTARY

1.4

**MODERATELY
ACTIVE**

1.6

**HIGHLY
ACTIVE**

1.8

Your BMR x Activity Level = TDEE

If your goal is to keep healthy and maintain weight then you should consume these calories.



3. WORKOUT YOUR TOTAL DAILY CALORIES

In the previous steps, you've learned how to calculate your maintenance calories. This is the number of calories you need to maintain your current weight.

To build muscle, you need to consume more calories than your maintenance calories. So, once you have your maintenance calories, simply add 200-300 calories to that figure - that's the number of calories you should eat per day to build muscle.

When you're ready to shed fat, you'll need to recalculate your maintenance calories as this will be different since you'd have gained some weight. Then, deduct 300-500 calories to shed some fat and be left with that lean physique you dream of.

IMPORTANT!

Remember to divide your total daily calories according to the macronutrient requirements:

- 1g of protein per 1 lb of bodyweight / multiply the grams by 4 to obtain the calories
- 50-55% carbohydrates / divide the calories by 4 to obtain the grams
- 30-35% fats / divide the calories by 9 to obtain the grams



VITAMINS AND MINERALS

WATER-SOLUBLE VITAMINS

Water-soluble vitamins are vitamins that dissolve in water easily. As a result, you need regular intakes of these.

B1

Helps to convert calories into usable energy. Sources include peas, fresh fruit and wholegrains. The RNI is set to 0.4mg per 1000 calories burnt.

B2

Supports the release of energy from fat and protein. Sources include liver, cheese, eggs and green vegetables. DRV is 11mg/day for females and 1.3mg/day for males.

B3

Supports energy production carbs and protein, healthy skin and digestive process. Sources include liver, beef, pork and fish. Recommended intake is 12-18mg per day.

B6

Supports the metabolism of amino acids, fats, and carbs. Also keeps immune system strong. Sources include meats, fish and nuts. Recommended intake is 1.2-1.4mg per day.

B7

Supports the metabolism of amino acids, fats, and carbs. Sources include almonds, walnuts, spinach and milk. Recommended intake is 10-200mcg per day.

B9

Vital for the manufacture of DNA and proteins, and proper growth and development. Sources include liver, spinach, broccoli, asparagus. RNI is set to 200mcg per day.

B5

Producing fats within cells. Sources include liver, mushrooms, cauliflower, and tomatoes. No specific recommendation been made but 5.4mcg per day is adequate.

B12

It important for normal growth and development. Sources include eggs, milk, cod, salmon, and fortified cereals. Recommended intake RNI is 1.5mcg per day.

C

Supports the formation of collagen to keep bones and connective tissues strong. Sources include grapefruit, kiwi fruit, mango and strawberries. Recommended intake is 40mg per day.

FAT-SOLUBLE VITAMINS

Fat-soluble vitamins can be stored in the body, so regular intakes are not necessary. These vitamins, when taken regularly, can build up in the liver and become toxic.

A

Crucial for vision in the dark, healthy skin and protecting respiratory tract. Sources include liver, carrots, dried apricots, soya beans. DRV is 600mcg/ day for women and 700mcg/day for men.

D

Helps the body absorb calcium and phosphate for healthy bones and teeth, and the immune system. Sources include oily fish and eggs. 25mcg per day has been said to be safe.

E

It is an antioxidant that protects your body from toxins inhaled from air. eg. pollution. Sources include avocado, nuts and seeds, spinach, broccoli. 4-8 mg per day is considered adequate.

K

Essential for the formation of blood-clotting proteins. Sources include broccoli, brussels sprouts, kale, spinach. The DRV is set between 0.5 and 1.0 mcg per 1 kg of bodyweight per day

MACRO-MINERALS

Macro-minerals are required in larger amounts to support certain body functions.

Calcium

Supports the creation and maintenance of strength and density of bones and teeth. Sources include milk, cheese, yogurt, spinach, broccoli. 700mg is suitable for most average persons.

Magnesium

Plays a vital role in the formation and strengthening of bones and teeth. Sources include wholegrain cereals, nuts and seeds, spinach. RNI is 270mg/day for women and 300mg/ day for men.

Phosphorous

Supports the production of energy. Sources include milk, cheese, fish, eggs. The RNI is set to 17.5 mmol per day.

Sodium

Regulates body's water content and works as part of nerve functioning. Sources include table salt. The DRV is set at 1600mg per day

Chloride

Important for regulating body's fluid content and helps produce digestive juices. Sources include seaweed, table salt, tomatoes and lettuce. The RNI is set to 2,500mg/day.

Sulphur

Supports the function of every living cell in the body. Sources include chickpeas, couscous, wholegrains, leafy vegetables. No recommended intake.

Potassium

Important for muscle and organs like heart, and regulated water within the body. Sources include peas, broccoli, lima beans, tomatoes, potatoes. The DRV is 3500mg perday.



MICRO-MINERALS

Macro-minerals are required in much smaller amounts to support certain body functions.

Iron

Supports oxygen distribution around the body. Sources include brown rice, dried apricots, soy bean flour, nuts. The RNI for women is 14.8mg/day and male 8.7mg/ day.

Copper

Plays a vital role in the body's antioxidant system, and strengthens the immune system. Sources include shellfish, whole grains, spinach. The DRV for adults is set to 1.2mg per day.

Manganese

Forms connective tissues, bones, blood clotting factors, and sex hormones. Sources include grains, clams, oysters, mussels, and nuts. The RNI is set to 1.8-2.3mg/day.

Zinc

Keeps the immune system strong. Sources include oysters, red meat, chickpeas, cashews and almonds. The RNI is set to 7-10mg/day.



YOUR NUTRITION DIARY

Take a note of your food and calories so you can track everything as you eat!

SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU		



SUPPLEMENTATION

There are many supplements on the market, and a lot of them have very little to no evidence behind them. However, I've scraped all the research and narrowed down the list of supplements that have been proven to work.

CREATINE

Creatine is a well-known and well-studied substance that has been shown to boost strength and power production during resistance exercise. This supplement is excellent for enhancing muscular contraction and lowering fatigue, both of which are critical components of your journey. The greater your ability to workout at a high level for an extended period of time, the better.

To begin, take 0.3g per kilogram of bodyweight per day for around 7 days, then 0.03g per kilogram of bodyweight per day for another 3 weeks. You can take a couple of weeks off and then resume, or you can just keep going.

WHEY PROTEIN

If you want a high-quality protein shake, go for one that has whey protein. This type of shake is easily absorbed by the body and has a balanced amino acid blend to aid muscle building and recovery.

A pro tip: To avoid stomach cramps and extra gas, use a protein supplement that was manufactured at low temperatures.

Take approximately 20-30g of whey protein within 45 minutes of exercise.



B-HYDROXY B-METHYLBUTYRATE (HMB)

HMB is a supplement that prevents muscle breakdown when you're on a low-calorie diet. This supplement can be very handy when you want to shed some fat and maintain muscle mass.

The recommended daily dosage is 3g. However, split that dosage throughout the day, and take 1g in the morning, 1 hour before exercise, and evening.

USEFUL VITAMINS AND MINERALS

Some vitamins are more useful at supporting muscle growth and recovery than others. Below is a list of 6 vitamins and minerals that support your journey.

CALCIUM

Calcium is crucial for bone health, muscular growth, muscle contraction, and neuron function. Your training and success may be hampered if you don't get enough calcium. Calcium can be found in a variety of foods, including milk, cheese, kale, spinach, and others.



IRON

Iron is essential for the development of red blood cells and the delivery of oxygen to the muscle and organs. This helps with energy levels and your immune system. Natural sources of iron include liver, red kidney beans, edamame, and chickpeas.

SELENIUM

Selenium plays an important role in the body's antioxidant defence mechanisms. Selenium may be beneficial in the prevention of fatigue and recovery. Whereas a deficiency can reduce exercise performance. Brazil nuts, tuna, pork meat, and other foods contain selenium.

VITAMIN D3

Muscle strength, anti-inflammatory, and anti-cancer properties are all aided by the production of proteins and enzymes. Salmon, sardines, herring, egg yolks, liver, and other foods contain it.

FISH OIL

Omega-3 fish oil contains both docosahexaenoic acid (DHA) and eicosapentaenoic acid (EPA). Omega-3 fatty acids are crucial nutrients that aid in the prevention and treatment of cardiovascular disease. Omega-3 fatty acids may assist to decrease blood pressure and improve joint health, according to the findings. Oily fish, flaxseed oil, chia seeds, canola oil, and other foods include fish oil.



EXERCISES BY MUSCLE GROUPS

To avoid muscular imbalance and to ensure that every major muscle group in the body looks well defined, it's critical to workout your entire body. Take a look at the key muscle groups and exercises for each one below.

THE FRONT OF THE BODY

SHOULDERS

Shoulder press, bent-over reverse fly, front raises, Arnold press, military press, lateral raises, pull-ups

TRAPS

Shrugs, upright rows, deadlifts, rack pulls, and cable face pull ins

CHEST

Barbell bench press, Incline bench press, decline bench press, push up, chest fly, push ups, cable flys

BICEPS

Bicep curls, chin ups, cable curls, preacher curls, hammer curls, concentration curls

FOREARMS

Reverse curls, zottman curls, hammer curls, pull-ups

ABS

Crunches, V ups, Bicycle crunches, power tower raises, clapping crunches X-man crunches, plank, side planks

QUADRICEPS

Squats, lunges, step ups, Bulgarian split squats, box jumps

THE BACK OF THE BODY

UPPER BACK

Pulls ups, bent over rows, seated rows, renegade rows

TRICEPS

Skull crushers, triceps kickback, triceps dips, cable extensions

LOWER BACK

Back extension, deadlifts, supermans

GLUTES

Squats, lunges, hip thrusts, stiff deadlifts, single leg deadlifts and single leg hip thrusts.

HAMSTRINGS

Barbell good mornings, leg curls, Romanian deadlifts, straight leg deadlifts

CALVES

Calf raises, jumping rope, jumping squats

As you can see, some muscle groups can be worked on using the same exercises. This means that you should work on these muscle groups on the same day. For instance, take a look at an example workout split below:

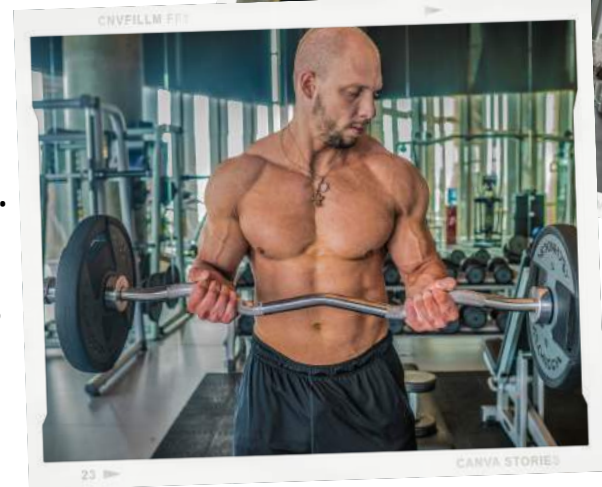
- Monday- Legs and glutes
- Tuesday- Back and biceps
- Wednesday - Chest and triceps
- Thursday - Abs and shoulders
- THEN REPEAT from the start



PROPER TRAINING, POSITION DURING EXERCISES AND BREATHING

Lifting heavy weights is what's going to grow the muscle for you. However, your form is actually more important than lifting weights. You should never compromise your form over heavier weights. This only sets you up for injuries and doesn't allow a full range of motion. Therefore, make sure to start off with the appropriate weight and then work your way up to heavier weights.

To start off, test your 1 REP MAX. This is a technique that puts your strength to the test. So, choose an exercise for the upper and lower body. For instance, you can use squats or leg press for the lower body and bench press for the upper body. All you going to do here is perform both exercises for only 1 rep. You will continue increasing the weights for just 1 rep until you reach a weight you can no longer lift. This means that your previous weight is your 1 REP MAX. Once you know your 1 REP MAX, reduce that weight by 30% - that is your starting point.





THE DO'S

Below is a list of things to take into consideration when you're building that healthy and beautiful body of yours.

LIFT PROPER WEIGHTS

As you've learned before, make sure to lift 70% of your 1 REP MAX. That is your starting point. You want to increase the weights by 2-3 kilograms every or every second week.

USE PROPER FORM

Move your joints through their complete range of motion when lifting weights. The better your form is, the greater your outcomes will be, and you will be less likely to injure yourself.

Slow down each movement and lift free weights with your muscles rather than your momentum. Swinging movements should be avoided. Lifting and lowering weights with control across the range of action will stimulate more muscle fibres. If you can't lift a weight without swinging it, it's too heavy for you, and you should reduce it.

Some tips on keeping proper form include:

- Standing tall with your chest elevated and arms at your sides is a good way to start. Don't hunch your shoulders or clench your neck. Maintain your core's involvement. Lifting weights will be more effective if your core is stronger.
- When you're working hard, you might be inclined to hold your breath. To fuel the movement, exhale during the most difficult section of the workout.



WORK ON YOUR BALANCE

Many people fall into the trap of exercising only specific muscles that they can see in the mirror. For instance, women are likely to work on glutes and abs whereas men are likely to work on the back and chest. However, by focusing on only certain areas of your body, you are likely to experience muscle imbalance. This can lead to more muscle knots and overall imbalance. make sure to work on all muscle groups mentioned at the start.

REST

Avoid working out the same muscles on consecutive days. Two or three times a week, you may work all of your major muscle groups in a single session, or you could schedule daily workouts for certain muscle groups. For example, on Monday, work on your legs and glutes, Tuesday on your chest and triceps, and so on. The rule of thumb is to avoid exercising the same muscle group for at least 48 hours.

THE DONT'S

NEVER SKIP THE WARM-UP

Stretching and warming up is important because it prepares your muscles for exercise. It warms them up and makes them more elastic. This helps muscle contraction and reduces the risk of injuries.



A sample stretching routine:

- Downward facing dog (10-second hold)
- Sky Reach (10-second hold)
- Toe Touch (10-second hold)
- Neck Roll (Rotate in both directions 2-3 times)
- Shoulder Roll (Rotate each arm in forward and backward 2-3 times)
- Shoulder Back Stretch (10-second hold)

A sample warm-up routine

- 15 Jumping jacks
- 20 jumping squats
- 20 jumping lunges (10 each leg)
- 10 push-ups
- 30- seconds mountain climbers

NEVER RUSH YOUR EXERCISE

Make sure to perform each exercise in a controlled manner, don't rush it. This is important because performing the exercise slowly helps you to isolate the muscles better and puts them under strain for longer. The longer they work for, the stronger they'll get.

DON'T OVERDO YOUR WORKOUTS

Many people believe that the more exercises you perform the better. However, the truth is that you shouldn't really perform more than 5-6 exercises per muscle group/workout.

If you feel like you can exercise more than that, then you haven't worked hard enough on your sets. If this the case, make sure to lift heavier next time.

LISTEN TO YOUR BODY

If you feel tired or experience any pain, make sure to give that muscle group a rest. If pain persists, always consult a medical professional.



7-DAY SAMPLE WORKOUT PLAN



MONDAY - LEGS AND GLUTES

Back squats	4 x 10
Front Squats	4 x 10
Bulgarian Squats	4 x 10
Hip Thrusts	4 x 10
Walking Lunges	3 x 15

TUESDAY - BACK AND BICEPS

Pull-ups	4 x 10
Deadlifts	4 x 10
Lateral pull downs	4 x 10
Bent over rows	4 x 10
Single dumbbell row	5 x 8
Bicep curls	3 x 12
Hammer curls	3 x 12

WEDNESDAY - CHEST AND TRICEPS

Bench press	3 x 12
Incline bench press	3 x 12
Decline bench press	3 x 12
Chest flys	4 x 10
Chest dips	3 x 15
Tricep kick backs	3 x 12
Skull crushers	3 x 12



THURSDAY - ABS

Crunches	1 x 16
Reverse crunches	1 x 16
90/90 crunches	1 x 16
Heel touches	1 x 30
Leg raises	1 x 20
Flutter kicks	45 secs
Plank	30 secs
Side plank (each side)	30 secs

FRIDAY - SHOULDERS

Shoulder press	4 x 10
Military press	4 x 10
Arnold press	4 x 10
Lateral shoulder raises	5 x 8
Front raises	5 x 8

SATURDAY - CARDIO

Walk	10,000 steps
OR	OR
Jog	3 miles
OR	OR
Stair master	15 minutes

SUNDAY - REST



On the next page, you can take a note of the type of exercises and weights you do over the next 30 days. This is a great way of tracking progress.



YOUR EXERCISE DIARY

Take a note of what you do through the week and the weights you use so you can keep track of your progress!

SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT



ANABOLICS

WHAT ARE STEROIDS?

Anabolic steroids are a man-made version of the male hormone testosterone. More testosterone allows you to simply create more muscle, but taking steroids without a suitable exercise regimen isn't going to be effective.

HOW DO STEROIDS WORK?

Your body has a threshold of the amount of muscle it can build. This threshold is what keeps you healthy, it's your body's way of telling you how much muscle it can handle without putting excessive strain on your heart. This limit is determined by a mix of hormone levels, primarily testosterone, as well as your body's inherent structure and constitution, as well as genetics. This means that if you use steroids and grow muscle past that threshold - you are facing a much higher risk of heart attack as the body will need to pump more blood. Below is a list of benefits and dangers of taking steroids. Taking them safely and as prescribed can be safe.

BENEFITS OF USING STEROIDS

- Improved athletic performance
- Minimize stress
- Build muscle
- Decrease in fat
- Deal with various medical conditions

DANGERS

MEN

- Reduced Sperm Quality
- Aggressive behaviors
- Infertility
- Mood swings
- Shrunk Testicles
- Paranoia
- Erectile Dysfunction
- Manic Behavior
- Baldness
- Hallucinations and delusions
- Increased risk of prostate cancer
- Death

TEENAGERS

- Severe Acne Stunted growth
- Stomach pain Premature aging of bones
- Muscle Growth
- Increased Levels of Testosterone

FOR WOMEN

- Facial and body hair growth
- Loss of breasts
- Swelling of clitoris
- A Deepened voice
- Increased sex drive
- Irregular periods
- Hair Loss
- Severe Acne





THANK YOU

I hope that you've enjoyed my handbook and you're ready to start building your healthy and beautiful body.

If you need further exercise and nutrition support. Please don't hesitate to contact me.

Book your workout with me

Let's connect on socials!



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